



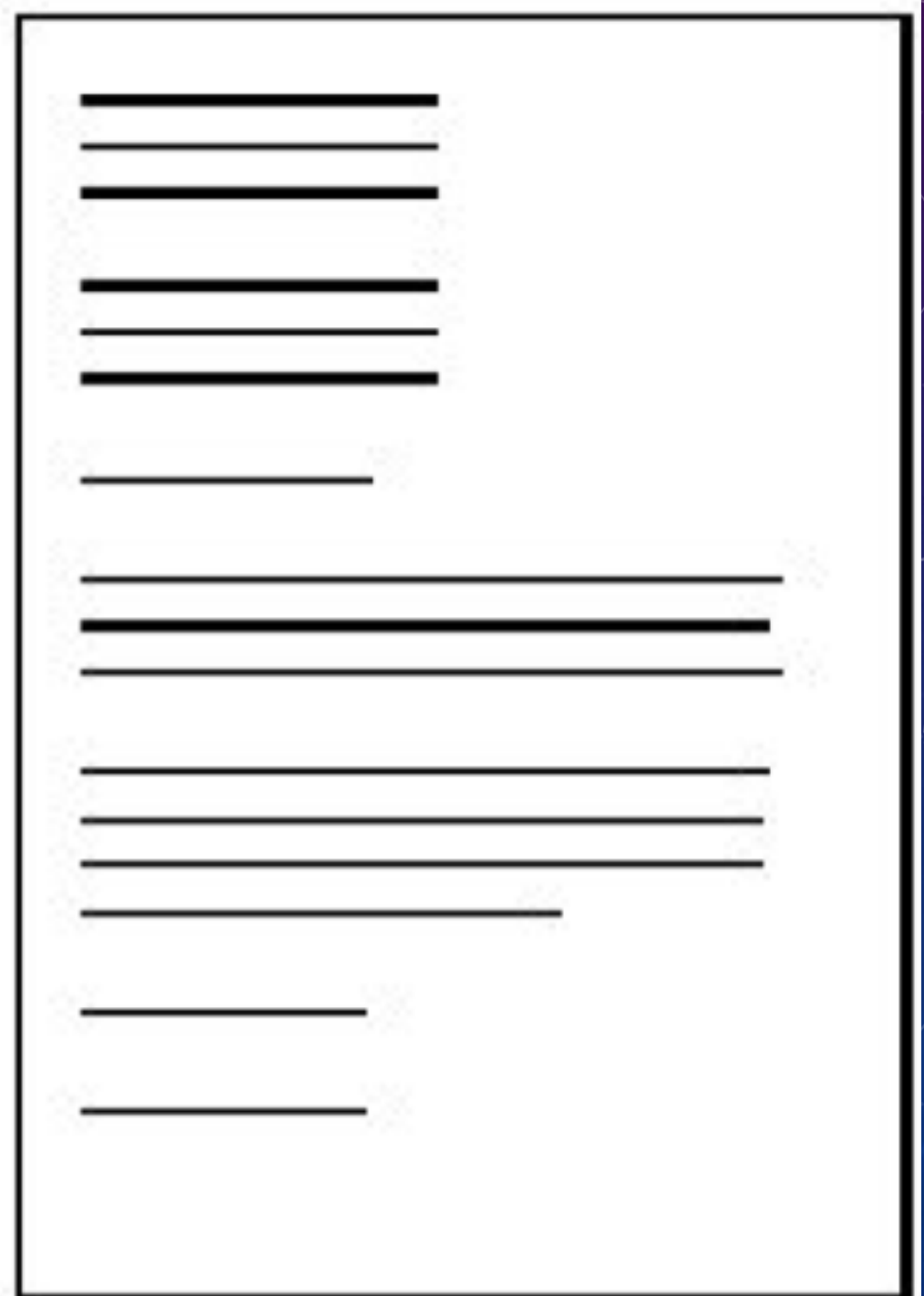
CHAPTER: 6

CORRESPONDENCE

BUSINESS LETTERS

LETTER FORMAT

- The fully block open punctuation style is the most common format for business letters.
- All the elements are lined up along an invisible line down the left side of the page. The text is single spaced, with no indent at the first paragraph of the sentence.



Sample Business Letter (Full Block Style)

Mrs. Clara Winters
12187 S. Polo Dr.
Fairfax, VA 22030

Return Address

May 26, 2002

Date

The Tiny Tots Toy Company
15456 Pyramid Way Inside
College Park, FL 33133

Address

Dear Customer Service Representative:

Salutation

I recently purchased one of your Tiny Tents (Model #47485) for my three-year old. Unfortunately, after viewing the components that came with the product, I discovered that four of the parts were missing. Also, the instructions that came with the tent are in Portuguese and Russian, but not in English or French, the two languages I speak. These two unforeseen problems have resulted in the tent remaining unassembled and unacceptable as a toy for my daughter.

Body

I am writing to request replacements for the missing parts, and a copy of the full set of assembly instructions (in English or French) for the model I purchased. If reasonable arrangements are not made within ten business days, I will return the tent to the store I purchased it from and expect a full refund. To assist you in processing my request, I am including a copy of my sales receipt and a list of the missing parts.

I have purchased other toys manufactured by your company in the past, and have always been impressed with the quality and selection that Tiny Tots has made available to its customers. I sincerely hope this is a one-time incident, and that any future purchases I make will live up to the standard my family has come to expect from your company.

Sincerely,

Closing

Signature

Clara Winters

Typed Name

Enc: 2

Attachments

- Letterhead

- Reference
- Date
- Inside address
- Salutation
- Heading
- 1st paragraph – Separate into paragraphs with a new idea in each, with one line space between each paragraph.
- Complimentary Close
- Sender's Name
- Title or Department
- Enclosure Indication

LAYOUT

A diagram illustrating the layout of a business letter. The letter is enclosed in a rectangular border. The elements are represented by horizontal lines of varying lengths and positions:

- Letterhead:** Three lines at the top left.
- Reference:** Three lines below the letterhead.
- Date:** Three lines below the reference.
- Inside address:** Three lines below the date.
- Salutation:** A single line below the inside address.
- Heading:** Three lines below the salutation.
- 1st paragraph:** A single line below the heading.
- 2nd paragraph:** Three lines below the first paragraph.
- 3rd paragraph:** Three lines below the second paragraph.
- 4th paragraph:** Three lines below the third paragraph.
- 5th paragraph:** A single line below the fourth paragraph.
- 6th paragraph:** A single line below the fifth paragraph.

EXAMPLES OF OPENING LINES

- I am writing to enquire about ...
- After having seen your advertisement in ... , I would like ...
- After having received your address from ... , I ...
- I received your address from ... and would like ...
- With reference to your letter of 8 June, I ...
- We/I recently wrote to you about ...
- Thank you for your letter of 8 May.
- Thank you for your letter regarding..
- Thank you for your letter/e-mail about ...
- In reply to your letter of 8 May...

EXAMPLES OF CLOSING LINES

- We look forward to a successful working relationship in the future.
- Should you need any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.
- Once again, I apologize for any inconvenience.
- We hope that we may continue to rely on your valued custom.
- I would appreciate your immediate attention to this matter.

PARTS OF A LETTER

1. Letterhead of your Organization
2. Date
3. Inside Address
4. Subject Line
5. Salutation
6. Body
7. Complimentary Closing
8. Writer's Signature Block
9. Your full name (typed)
10. End Notations CC



1. LETTER OF ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

- Sent to acknowledge receipt of something when a written record is appropriate.
- An acknowledge may also be sent to acknowledge receipt of another letter or document which requires further attention. As such you would clearly state that you will look into the matter and reply in more detail at a later date.

Dear Ms Hyams

Thank you for your letter of 17 January in which you enquire about our company finance services.

I have pleasure in enclosing a leaflet which gives full details of the services we offer, and also supplies some information about the company's history and present size and condition.

Should you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Yours sincerely

H L Warner

Customer Services Manager

2. LETTER OF ENQUIRY

- Enquiries for information about goods or services are sent and received in business all the time.
- In your letter remember to state clearly exactly what you want – information? a catalogue? a price list? a quotation?
- Keep your enquiry brief and to the point.

Dear Sir

Our company is currently renewing its computer equipment in the accounts department.

I am writing to enquire about the possibility of a representative of your company visiting us to advise about the number and kind of desk-top computers we need to provide an up-to-date system for our rapidly expanding business.

Perhaps you would like to telephone my secretary to arrange an appointment to call and discuss the matter with me.

Yours faithfully

P L Mackintosh
Accounts Manager

3. LETTER OF COMPLAINT

- When you have a genuine complaint, you will feel angry but remember that the other party may not to be blame .
- They may have a perfectly good defense. Therefore, your letter should be confined to a statement of the facts followed by an enquiry about what the company will do about it or a suggestion of how you expect the matter to be dealt with.
- At all costs **avoid rudeness** .

27 June 20..

Dear Mr. Green,

Re: telephone conversation Wednesday 2 June 20..-non-delivery of wardrobe

It would seem that you have been unable to trace my wardrobe in your warehouse as a further three days have elapsed since our last telephone conversation and my wardrobe has not arrived.

I have now waited for six weeks and frankly, were it not for the fact that it forms parts of a fully fitted (matching) bedroom, would have preferred to cancel my order.

At this stage I would like a guaranteed date of delivery and recompense for the inconvenience you have caused me. I have had to take three days' holiday to date to await delivery of the aforesaid wardrobe.

I would appreciate your earliest attention to this matter.

Yours sincerely,

Mrs. J. Brown

USEFUL PHRASES FOR LETTER OF COMPLAINT

- I am displeased with the quality of these goods.
- This is causing us a great deal of inconvenience.
- Please look into this and arrange for the goods to be replaced.
- These goods are well below the standard expected.
- I expect to receive a complete refund soon.
- The standard of workmanship is totally inadequate.
- You assured me that you would deliver these goods within one week.

4. ADJUSTMENT LETTER

- Adjustment letter gives an opportunity to investigate, explain and put things right.

February 3, 2001

Ms. Alma D. Alcantara ♦ EDP Enterprise ♦ Pasay, Paranaque

Dear Mrs. Alcantara:

We are sorry to hear about the poor performance of your new air-conditioning unit.

We suggest that you explain the dissatisfaction you are having to our air-conditioner technical person whom we are sending to your place.

We are always glad to be of service to you.

Sincerely,
Jenlyn M. Tapang

USEFUL PHRASES FOR LETTER OF ADJUSTMENT

- I have looked into this matter and have found out that...
- I am very sorry to hear about...
- Please accept my apologies for any inconvenience caused.
- Thank you for bringing the matter to our attention.
- I sincerely hope that you will have no further problems with this replacement order.

DON'TS OF LETTER WRITING

- Make grammar or usage errors
- Use clichés or worn-out phrases
- Use obsolete and/or pompous language because it "seems" more professional
- Be too familiar with your audience
- Use humor unless you know what you are doing
- Preach
- Brag

DON'TS OF LETTER WRITING

- Use plain English
- Write in active voice when possible
- Use short sentences when possible
- Use everyday words and avoid technical jargon
- Use lists to present complex materials
- Select the words you use very carefully
- Use a strong organizational strategy
- Use a reader centered tone
- Use a business like, conversational tone

LETTER VS MEMO

Letter

- Letters are used both external communication (mostly)
- A letter requires inside address, Salutation and complimentary close.
- Communicating to external people through letter, simple words are encouraged rather than jargons.

Memo

- A memo is used internally within an organization moving upward, downward or horizontally. It is never sent outside.
- A memo may omit return address, salutation, complimentary close if it uses To, from, Date and Subject heading.
- Memo can use technical jargons and abbreviations because their meaning is understood by the people within the organization.

Memos should contain the following key **components**:

- Memo ID
- Introduction
- Discussion
- Conclusion

DATE:

TO: Focus + Topic

FROM:

S

Introduction: A lead-in, warm up, overview, stating why you are writing and what you are writing about

Discussion: Detailed development, made accessible through highlighting techniques, explaining exactly what you want to say

Conclusion: A summation stating what is next, when this will occur, and why the date is important

EXAMPLES

One-word **subject** lines don't communicate effectively, e.g.

Flawed: Subject: COMPTROLLERS

Corrected: Subject: Salary Increase For Comptrollers

Introduction - example

1. In the third of our series of quality control meetings this quarter, I'd like to get together again to determine if improvements have been made.
2. As a follow-up to our phone conversation yesterday (8/12/05). I have met with your VP regarding your suggestions, He'd like to meet with you to discuss the following ideas in more detail.

Conclusion

A complimentary close: If our quarterly sales continue to improve at this rate, we will double our sales expectations by 2005.
Congratulation!

A directive close: Next Wednesday (12/22/05), Mr. Jones will provide each of you a timetable of events and a summary of accomplishments.

MEMO

DATE: January 19, 2005
TO: Tom Lisk
FROM: Juliet Kincaid
SUBJECT: PRODUCING THE ANNOY-NO-MORE CALL
SCREENING MACHINE.

Subject line should not
end with periods

Good technical writing
should be concise—this
sentence is too long

Our product development staff has come up with a breakthrough new product, a phone answering machine that answers the phone, screens calls, and, by voice activation, routes the call to an appropriate message and gives a busy signal when the person doesn't want to be bothered.

Grammatically, this colon
is used incorrectly

We have researched this product fully and believe it would benefit our company because:

1. The product has a relatively simple design that occupies no more space than a regular phone and can be designed for wall or desk mounting.
2. The cost for manufacturing is low compared to the retail value. The unit costs approximately \$100.00 to produce and retails for \$999.99.
3. The unit can be interchanged easily with all phone networks including MBB and Shout.

"around" is vague word
usage

We would like to begin mass production around April 1, 2005. Our Westport facility could handle the production with the addition of 10 technicians and engineers to aid in production. We hope you give this product consideration and endorse it fully. Thanks.